



The Power of Aesthetics

An international and interdisciplinary Summer School

Aug. 22 – 30, 2026

Shanghai International Studies University (SISU), Shanghai

Organizers:

- Neurocognitive Image Laboratory (NIL) & World Arthistory Institute (WAI) of Shanghai International Studies University (SISU), Shanghai, China
- Institute of Medical Psychology (IMP), Ludwig Maximilian University (LMU), Munich, Germany
- Federation of German Scientists (VDW, Vereinigung Deutscher Wissenschaftler), Berlin, Germany

Language: English

Participants: International and Chinese undergraduates, graduates, and postdocs.

Benefits: Free accommodation and meals are provided, no tuition fees. Participants of the Summer School may receive a certificate of attendance from the Institute of Medical Psychology (IMP), Ludwig Maximilian University (LMU), Munich, Germany.

Faculty and Lectures



Prof. Ernst Pöppel, SISU, LMU, Germany. Neuroaesthetics, Cognitive neuroscience



Prof. Yan BAO, SISU, PKU, China. Neuroaesthetics, Cognitive neuroscience



Prof. Nikos Logothetis ICPBR, Shanghai, China; MPI-BC, Tübingen, Germany. Brain science



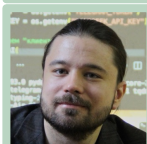
Prof. LaoZhu, SISU, PKU, China. Cultural Heritage, Art History, Artist, Art historian



Prof. Jacek Rogala, University Warsaw, Poland Neuroinformatics, Neuroaesthetics



Beata Bajno, Visual Artist and Architect, Warsaw, Poland. Visual art, Architecture



Dr. Gleb Vzorin, Lomonosov Moscow State University, Russia. Psychology, HMI, AI



Prof. Helmut Leder, Vienna University, Austria. Psychology, Empirical Aesthetics



Prof. Jörg Fingerhut, Humboldt University, Germany. Philosophy, Cognitive Science



Dr. Maria Reinisch, Managing director of VDW, Germany. Leadership, Ecology



Prof. Shabnam Kadir, University of Hertfordshire, UK. Computational Neuroscience



Alexander Benz, Lawyer, LMU, Germany. Medical Psychology, Neuroethics, Neuroaesthetics



Prof. Elvira Barkhatova, IKBFU, Kaliningrad, Russia. Linguistics, Neurolinguistics



Prof. Yao LI, SISU, Shanghai, China. Psychology, AI, Human Factors

Title of the lectures, followed by discussions

Ernst Pöppel: Time Windows: How the Brain Makes Cognition Possible

Yan Bao: Appreciation of Visual Art: Anthropological Universals and Cultural Specifics

Nikos Logothetis: Delving into the Multiscale Organization of Brain Systems

LaoZhu: The ontology of Chinese Paintings

Jacek Rogala: Art Perception in Lab and Gallery: Who's Cheating Whom?

Beata Bajno: Laboratory of Presence - What Happens When We Interact with Different Forms of Light?

Helmut Leder: Empirical Aesthetics - History, Concepts, and Studies on "What is Beauty"

Jörg Fingerhut: Wonder and the Power of Art: How Aesthetic Emotions Transform Understanding?

Maria Reinisch: Bridging East and West: Rethinking Leadership for a Complex World

Shabnam Kadir: A Hidden "Golden Rule" of Abstract Art

Alexander Benz: Between Motivation and Manipulation: Nudge or Novel Manipulation?

Elvira Barkhatova: Fletz, Bummelzwock, and the Eye of the Beholder

Gleb Vzorin: From Thesis Art to Elegant Theories: Beauty in Everyday Scientific Work

Yao LI: Visual Rhythm in Time: How Temporal Structure Shapes Attention and Visual Search

Recruiting!

(Deadline: June.30th)

Please send a **short Motivation Letter** and a **short CV** to:
nil@shisu.edu.cn and cc to: baoyan@pku.edu.cn and
Ernst.Poeppel@med.uni-muenchen.de

Summer School Schedule

	8:00– 9:00	9:00– 10:30	10:30– 11:00	11:00– 12:30	12:45– 15:00	15:00– 16:30	16:30– 18:30	19:00– 20:30
Aug 22 (Sat)	Arrival and Hotel Check-in				Registration			
Aug 23 (Sun)	Break fast	Orientation		Lunch	Visit Campus		Reception	
Aug 24 (Mon)	Break fast	Lecture: Ernst Pöppel	Coffee Break	Lecture: Yan BAO	Lunch	Lecture: Helmut Leder	Dinner	Student Presen- tations
Aug 25 (Tue)	Break fast	Lecture: LaoZhu	Coffee Break	Lecture: Beata Bajno	Lunch	Lecture: Jacek Rogala	Dinner	Student Presen- tations
Aug 26 (Wed)	Break fast	Lecture: Alexander Benz	Coffee Break	Lecture: Maria Reinisch	Lunch	Lecture: Shabnam Kadir	Dinner	Student Presen- tations
Aug 27 (Thu)	Break fast	Lecture: Elvira Barkhatova	Coffee Break	Lecture: Nikos Logothetis	Lunch	Lecture: Gleb Vzorin	Dinner	Group Work with Faculty
Aug 28 (Fri)	Break fast	Lecture: Jörg Fingerhut	Coffee Break	Lecture: Yao LI	Lunch	Group Work with Faculty	Dinner	Dinner and Cele- bration
Aug 29 (Sat)	Break fast	Presentation of group work	Coffee Break	Presentation of group work	Lunch	Free time	Dinner	Free time
Aug 30 (Sun)	Break fast	Departure						